

Northern Berkshire Astronomical Society

Founded 2023 | North Adams Public Library | North Adams, MA

This Month

The Moon

☀ - Sep 7: Corn Moon

☾ - Sep 14

🌑 - Sep 21

☾ - Sep 29

Planets

Mercury: in Vir, behind the Sun

Venus: in Leo early AM

Jupiter: is in Gem, rises ~1AM

Saturn: is in Psc, up all night

Uranus: is in Tau, rises ~10PM

Neptune: in Psc, near Saturn

Deep Sky Objects

Easy (binoculars): M 11, M 4, C 20 (challenge), the Scutum and Sagittarius star clouds.

Moderate (small telescopes): M 55, M 20, M 27, M 16, M 17

Challenges: C 33/34, M 69, M 70, C 57, p Oph, NGC 6781

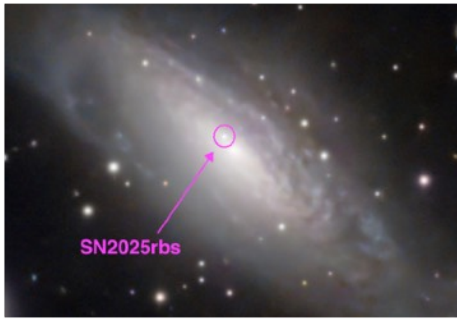


NBAS 2nd Anniversary!

This month we celebrate our 2nd year with our first “official” public night-time event! On Friday the 26th, we’ll set up telescopes at Greylock Visitor’s Center in Lanesborough (weather permitting), with a lecture on “The History of the Constellations”.

Event at Greylock Visitor’s Center!

Join us on Friday the 26th in Lanesborough for our first sponsored public observing event at Mt. Greylock Visitor’s Center, where several members will have their telescopes pointed at popular Fall objects, Saturn (and maybe Neptune?), and the thin crescent Moon. While the scopes are being set up, inside there’s a talk “Mapping the Skies: the History of the Constellations” where we’ll discover how and when our familiar constellations came to be (and a bunch of “ex-constellations along the way!



This Month's Image

NGC 7331 is the primary galaxy in the "Deer Lick Group" in Pegasus in which a supernova was discovered on 14 July when it was mag 17. It has since brightened to mag 11.9.

This image was taken 19 Jul with an eQuinox2 (4.5") telescope, 35m exposure, and the estimated magnitude is 13.2.

Interacting

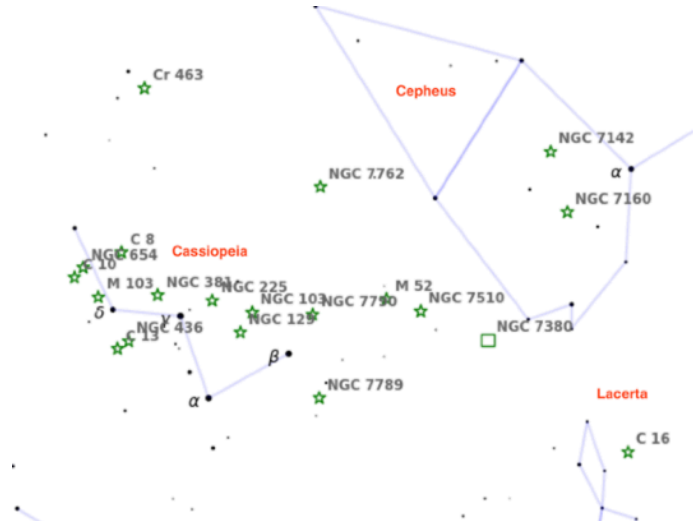
Check out our Facebook Group

<https://www.facebook.com/groups/nberkastro>

and join us at our next meeting:
October 1st at 6 PM at the
North Adams Public Library

Events

Sep. 26: Observing/Lecture at the Greylock Visitor's Center in Lanesborough. Look through member telescopes, and a lecture on "The History of the Constellations"! (Free.)



Fall is For Open Clusters!

Even though the Summer Milky Way is getting lower in the sky and setting earlier, the Fall Milky Way has much to offer, especially in binoculars and small telescopes!

Stretching from Perseus (with the famous “Double Cluster”) all the way across Cassiopeia, Cepheus, and even Lacerta (with a few more in Andromeda), there are *dozens* of open clusters to discover! Just scanning from one end to the other (all the way to Deneb) you’re treated to one after another after another, all different sizes, shapes, concentrations, many with nice color contrasts in the brighter stars. The map above just shows a few of the more well known ones:

Binocular Targets:

Caldwell 8 (NGC 559) in Cassiopeia

Caldwell 10 (NGC 663) the "Lawnmower Cluster" in Cassiopeia*Caldwell 13* (NGC 457) the “Dragonfly Cluster” in Cassiopeia

Caldwell 16 (NGC 7243) in Lacerta

Collinder 463 the “Queen’s Reflection” in Cassiopeia

Messier 52 in Cassiopeia

Messier 103 in Cassiopeia

NGC 225 the “Sailboat Cluster” in Cassiopeia

NGC 654 the “Fuzzy Butterfly Cluster” in Cassiopeia

NGC 7160 the “Swimming Alligator Cluster” in Cepheus

NGC 7380 the “Wizard Nebula” (and cluster) in Cepheus

NGC 7510 the “Dormouse Cluster” in Cepheus

NGC 7789 "Caroline's Rose Cluster" in Cassiopeia

NGC 7790 the “Widow’s Web Cluster” in Cassiopeia